

UNITED NATIONS **NATIONS UNIES**
DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMIC AND SOCIAL AFFAIRS

**ITALIAN FELLOWSHIPS PROGRAMME
FOR TECHNICAL COOPERATION
CAPACITY BUILDING AND HUMAN RESOURCES DEVELOPMENT
2025-2026**

Fellowship Award Specification

**United Nations Office for Project Services (UNOPS)
South-East Asia and Pacific Multi-country Office (EAPMCO)**

1. General Information

<u>Title:</u>	UN Fellow
<u>Orientation Workshop dates:</u>	May 2026 (tbc)
<u>Assignment in the field dates:</u>	May 2026 – May 2027 (tbc)
<u>Duty Station:</u>	Bangkok, Thailand
<u>Sector of assignment:</u>	Project Management

2. Supervision

<u>Name of the Supervisor:</u>	Mr. Jonathan Thalla-Joel
<u>Title of the Supervisor:</u>	Head of Project Management Office

3. Background information

UNOPS supports the successful implementation of its partners' peacebuilding, humanitarian and development projects around the world. Our mission is to serve people in need by expanding the ability of the United Nations, governments and other partners to manage projects, infrastructure and procurement in a sustainable and efficient manner.

Working in some of the world's most challenging environments, our vision is to advance sustainable implementation practices, always satisfying or surpassing our partners' expectations. With over 7,000 personnel spread across 80 countries, UNOPS offers its partners the logistical, technical and management

knowledge they need, wherever they need it. A flexible structure and global reach means that we can quickly respond to our partners' needs, while offering the benefits of economies of scale.

The South East Asia and Pacific Multi Country Office (EAPMCO) supports, develops, and oversees the UNOPS portfolio of projects in South East Asia and the Pacific. EAPMCO was established in January 2023 following the merger of the Thailand Multi-Country Office, which covered 20 countries across North East Asia, South East Asia and the Pacific, and the Cambodia Multi-Country Office, which covered 4 countries in South East Asia - 3 countries in the Mekong Sub-region (Cambodia, Lao PDR, and Vietnam) and the Philippines. EAPMCO currently covers 24 countries across North East Asia, South East Asia and the Pacific. With its head office in Bangkok, the Multi-Country Office comprises seven business units: Thailand, Indonesia, the Pacific Operations Cluster, Papua New Guinea, China, Mekong, and the Philippines.

In 2024, the UNOPS EAPMCO implemented projects worth more than USD 81 million, in the areas of Energy Transition, Resilient Infrastructure, Digital Transformations, Sustainable Environmental Management, Climate Change, Waste Management, Rule of Law and Access to Justice, Water, Sanitation and Hygiene (WASH), Post Conflict Reintegration, Emergency Relief, Post COVID19 Economic Transformations, and Health, through HR, procurement, construction, contract management, and fund and program management services.

The projects reflect the Multi-Country Office's (MCO) commitment to sustainable development across the 24 countries of the Asia-Pacific region. With a focus on long-lasting infrastructure, energy transition, climate change, and sustainable environmental management, EAPMCO actively supports initiatives that reduce environmental impacts and promote resilience to climate risks. Examples of projects include Coastal Protection in Kirabati (Pacific), Climate Villages in Indonesia, Energy Transition Policy in Southeast Asia, Sustainable Infrastructure and Renewable Energy projects in Papua New Guinea and the Philippines.

The Fellow will be part of the Project management Office (PMO) team which provides monitoring, oversight, and advisory support to all projects and programs in the South East Asia and Pacific Multi-Country Office (EAPMCO) with projects being implemented in Thailand, China, Cambodia, Laos, Vietnam, Philippines, Indonesia, Timor-Leste, Papua New Guinea, and several Pacific Islands. Sustainable development is central to all projects supported by the PMO, ensuring that each initiative fosters long-term environmental stewardship, social inclusion, and economic resilience. Therefore, the incumbent will receive exposure to different types of projects across multiple sectors (including health, WASH, nutrition, energy transition, digital transformation, renewable energy, SIDS resilience and sustainability, and humanitarian-development-peace nexus).

Under the direct supervision of the Head of PMO, the Fellow will ensure that relevant UNOPS policies, processes, and methods are followed and practiced across all projects within the Multi-Country Office. The function of the unit is to provide appropriate oversight to projects, advice and guidance to Project Managers and Project Executives, and increase the overall maturity of project and program management across the Multi-Country Office. The Fellow will actively contribute to moving EAPMCO toward achieving its mission-focused goals and objectives.

4. Duties, responsibilities and output expectations:

Within the framework of the Fellowships Programme for Technical Cooperation Capacity Building and Human Resources Development, the candidate will perform the following duties:

Programme and project development and planning

- Work with project teams to develop, review, and strengthen procurement plans and implementation strategies, ensuring alignment with project goals, timelines, and donor requirements.
- Provide appropriate levels of programmatic management and related support to the Head of PMO regarding all ongoing project activities, while maintaining and implementing appropriate standards and best practices in line with UNOPS policies and procedures.
- Directly contribute to strategic oversight, advice, and direction on program and project management activities in line with service agreements and project documents.
- Support proper development, implementation, and amendments of project budgets and resources.
- Contribute to the development and maintenance of various project management and oversight tools and templates for use within the PMO, complementary to UNOPS' online tools, to ensure effective planning, forecasting, and tracking of projects across the EAPMCO.
- Review new proposals, engagements, and amendments including advising on the feasibility of new projects proposed, overseeing budget development, ensuring linkages to relevant SDGs and benefits, and facilitating review of legal agreements.
- Facilitate the development of high-level program/project plans, including the collation of lower-level plans into program/project-level milestones.

Monitoring and reporting

- Support the Head of the PMO (and relevant Country Managers) with necessary project analysis reports and information to support areas relevant to the project management team.
- Perform routine maintenance and implementation of effective monitoring and evaluation systems of program and project activities.
- Develop, track, and report against key performance indicators for projects, PMO, and implementation countries.
- Support projects in developing appropriate monitoring frameworks, and result indicators, and guiding appropriate and impactful reporting of results.
- Provide advisory support and oversight to programs and projects, ensuring effective and timely dissemination of reports, in line with project documentation and clients' expectations.
- Support with development, tracking, and reporting of country strategies.
- Assist in developing monitoring frameworks and result indicators for procurement-related activities.

Oversight, advice, and quality assurance

- Complete regular quality assurance activities on all projects including procurement plans to ensure compliance with UNOPS defined standards for program/project management.
- Coordinate quality reviews of program/project documents and financial and programmatic deliverables.
- Provide quality control for management products (project documents, reports, etc.).
- Provide routine oversight and analysis of delivery data within the dashboard system, using the UNOPS ERP system as required.
- Identify, and anticipate potential risks and issues and advise mitigating measures to the Head of PMO in a timely manner.
- Support the development of stakeholder profiles, stakeholder engagement strategies, and project communications plans.

- Advise projects and programs on various implementation challenges and project management best practices; guide users on UNOPS tools, templates, and systems as required.
- Support key stakeholders (including Country Managers, Project Executives, Head of Program, and Head of PMO) to continuously identify and improve operational processes relevant to project implementation.
- Oversee and guide PMs on procurement processes for goods, services and work, ensuring adherence to UNOPS procurement rules and regulations.
- Implement control systems for procurement operations
- Ensure supplier and contract performance are properly managed, in compliance with agreed benchmarks and reporting mechanisms

Knowledge management and innovation

- Support routine and effective capacity building activities to build the long-term and sustainable capacity of staff.
- Support knowledge sharing related to procurement processes and practices.
- Actively interact with PMs and projects to share case studies, lessons learned, and best practices.
- Contribute to the oversight of lessons learned procedures, ensuring that lessons learned are shared in a timely and appropriate manner.

Impact of Results

The Fellow directly impacts on achievement of project results by assisting the Head of PMO to implement effective project management methods and strategies, reduce risks, cut costs and improve success rates. This consequently reinforces the visibility and image of UNOPS as an effective service provider in project services and management and strengthens its competitive position as a partner of choice in sustainable development and project services.

5. Qualifications and Experience

Education

- An advanced university degree (Master's or equivalent) in Project Management, Development Studies, International Relations, Political Sciences, Social Sciences, Business Administration, Engineering, or other built environment field.
- Certifications in Prince2 Foundation, Practitioner, PMP, MSP, or any other project management methodologies are desired.

Work experience

- One (1) year of relevant practical experience in project management, project support, development projects or implementation and/or oversight of programmes and projects.
- Previous experience working within a PMO environment or handling PMO functions is an asset.
- Previous experience working on project management/project implementation/project support in a developing country is an asset.
- Previous experience in the South East Asia or Pacific regions is an asset.
- Previous experience with the United Nations (and related organizations), or knowledge of UN project management tools, UN financial and procurement rules and regulations, and financial management tools, is an asset.
- Experience with data analysis, dashboard development, management reporting, project management tools, and information management systems (i.e. Oracle-based platforms) is an asset.

Languages

- Full working knowledge of English is required.
- Fluency in one or more additional official UN languages is considered an asset.

Competencies



Efficiently establishes an appropriate course of action for self and/or others to accomplish a goal. Actions lead to total task accomplishment through concern for quality in all areas. Sees opportunities and takes the initiative to act on them. Understands that responsible use of resources maximizes our impact on our beneficiaries.



Open to change and flexible in a fast paced environment. Effectively adapts one's own approach to suit changing circumstances or requirements. Reflects on experiences and modifies own behavior. Performance is consistent, even under pressure. Always pursues continuous improvements.



Evaluates data and courses of action to reach logical, pragmatic decisions. Takes an unbiased, rational approach with calculated risks. Applies innovation and creativity to problem-solving.

6. Learning Elements

At the end of the assignment the fellow will be able to:

- Develop, monitor, and report on key performance indicators (KPIs) for programs and projects.
- Design and implement results-based monitoring frameworks and indicators.
- Develop and critically review complex procurement plans and associated implementation strategies.
- Design, develop, and maintain essential project management tools and templates.
- Review and analyze legal and contractual agreements to ensure compliance and alignment.
- Apply knowledge of donor requirements to ensure project strategies are fully aligned.
- Implement and uphold relevant organizational policies and best practices (e.g., UNOPS policies) within project execution.
- Provide strategic oversight and advisory services for core project management activities.
- Perform data analysis and oversight using ERP and dashboard systems to track delivery performance.
- Formulate and advise on proactive risk identification, analysis, and mitigation strategies.
- Guide and oversee procurement processes by applying deep expertise in relevant procurement rules and regulations.
- Facilitate and lead lessons learned sessions and the dissemination of best practices.
- Implement and manage formal organizational learning and knowledge management procedures.

7. Content and methodology of the supervision

The Fellow will be considered a full member of the team and will contribute substantially to the purpose of the PMO and to project and programme delivery of UNOPS EAPMCO portfolio. In order to do so, the Fellow will be provided with the necessary guidance and training.

Following the initial weeks and the successful completion of mandatory induction trainings, the Fellow will develop performance objectives in agreement with the Head of PMO. These objectives

(approximately four to six) will include both performance objectives and development goals and will guide the Fellow's assignment of tasks throughout the Fellowship period.

Regular weekly 1-1 meetings will be held with the Head of PMO to discuss progress on tasks and roadblocks. These will be supplemented by ad-hoc meetings required to ensure continuous guidance and support. A quarterly meeting will be held to review progress against development goals. A mid-year review and annual review will be conducted to formally assess progress towards both performance objectives and development goals. The Fellow will also participate in team meetings, workshops, and training sessions.

8. Living conditions in the country

Thailand is categorized at a Level 2 security risk by UNDSS, with generally low crime, though opportunistic crimes like pickpocketing and bag snatching can occur. The country is considered to have one of the best health systems in Southeast Asia, and private hospitals are recommended for expats for their superior care and English-speaking staff. Common health risks include traffic accidents, mosquito-borne diseases, gastro-intestinal conditions, and rabies from the large stray dog population.

Bangkok, the capital, is an international city and the focal point for Thailand's educational, medical, commercial, and communication networks. As a global city, a wide range of goods are available, though imported items may have high tariffs. The rapid growth of the city, with over a million registered vehicles, has led to heavy traffic congestion, especially during rush hours, and an increasing problem with air pollution. However, the BTS "Skytrain" and MRT "subway" provide quick, efficient, and air-conditioned alternatives for travel. Accommodation for expats, such as houses, condos, and apartments, is concentrated in the center, particularly in areas like Sukhumvit and Sathorn Roads, with apartments and condominiums often offering 24-hour security and extra facilities like swimming pools.